> severance of Burma from India, it is difficult to understand how the Hindus can object to the severance of an area like Pakistan, which, to repeat, is politically detachable from, socially hostile and spiritually alien to, the rest of India.

For the sake of clarity, I repeat that my reliance on Dr. Ambedkar's views on the subject is limited to the extent of demonstrating that the recognition of Middle Eastern coloniality is imperative in the context of Bharat alongside European coloniality. I am alive to Dr. Ambedkar's views on Indic OETs, in particular on the caste system; however, given the undeniable existence of European coloniality during his life and times and his own colonial education, it is imperative to revisit his views on caste applying the filter of decoloniality *without* denying his experience or those of others. What is important for the present discussion is that notwithstanding Dr. Ambedkar's views on native OETs, he did *not* lose sight of the fact that Middle Eastern colonialism had its origins in OETs that lay outside the pale of the Indic civilisational fabric.

Critically, Dr. Ambedkar was clear that if the remnants of a culture were to be wiped out from a certain territory, the culture's connection with the territory and any claim it may have over it were weakened. While his observations were in the context of creation of Pakistan, we would do well to remember that what constitutes Pakistan today was part of Bharat once and therefore, if Bharat's indigeneity does not realise the imperative of a decolonialising exercise, it is bound to witness yet another cession of civilisational space, not just 'territory'. After all, the creation of Pakistan is not too far back in time and the event has not put an end to Middle Eastern colonialism; instead, it has only provided a firm launch pad for the systematic advancement of Middle Eastern colonialism through the instrumentality of a State that was expressly created for the attainment of the said goal. Venkat Dhulipala's work in this regard on the founding and organising principles of Pakistan is an example of stellar scholarship that only bolsters this position.

In his book *Creating a New Medina*, Dhulipala demonstrates, based on research surrounding the ideation and eventual creation of Pakistan, that it was conceived of as the 'New Medina'.[18] To support this position, Dhulipala cites the statements and efforts of proponents of Pakistan, such as Maulana Shabbir Ahmad Usmani, one of the founding members of Jamia Millia